IGP REM Material

6th Nov | Anik Mondal

Sessions covered in this REM:

- **Session 6:** Power & Influence
- **Session 7:** Understanding team roles/styles
- **Session 8:** Teams & Cross Cultural Challenges
- **Session 9:** Global & Virtual Team Challenges
- **Session 10-11:** Group Decision Making
- **Session 12:** Guest Faculty: Managing and Leading Multicultural Teams
- **Session 13-14:** Diversity & Teams
- **Session 15:** Managing Teams in Crisis
- Sessions 1-5 also in syllabus

- **Cases**
- **Readings**
- **Slides**
- **Forum Discussions**
- **Class Exercises**

Understanding team roles/styles

Session 7

Readings

1. The New Science Of Team Chemistry (Pioneers, Drivers, Integrators, Guardians)
2. The New Science Of Team Chemistry (If You Understand How The Brain Works, You Can Reach Anyone)

Slides & Class Exercise

- **Pioneers, Guardians, Drivers & Integrators (Reading)**
- **Belbin's 9 team role models**

Understanding team roles/styles: Reading

Step 1

	Pioneer	Integrator	Driver	Guardian
Harry Potter / *Marvel*	*Weasley Brothers* *Tony Stark (Iron Man)*	*Luna Lovegood* *Pepper Potts*	*Sirius Black* *Captain America*	*Hermione Granger* *Vision*
Style	• Outgoing • Focused on big picture • Spontaneous • Drawn to risk • Adaptable • Imaginative	• Diplomatic • Empathic • Traditional • Relationship-oriented • Intrinsically motivated • Nonconfrontational	• Quantitative • Logical • Focused • Competitive • Experimental • Deeply curious	• Methodical • Reserved • Detail-oriented • Practical • Structural • Loyal
Energized by	• Brainstorming • Spontaneity & trying new things • Enthusiasm	• Collaboration • Communication • Trust & Respect	• Solving problems • Directness • Winning	• Organization • Predictability & consistency • A detailed plan
Alienated by	• Rules & Structure • The word “No” • A focus on process	• Politics • Conflict • Inflexibility	• Indecision • Inefficiency • Lack of focus	• Disorder • Time pressure • Ambiguity & uncertainty

Managing different team roles/styles: Reading

Step 2

Pull Opposite types together

Guardian vs Pioneer

Overpreparation & afraid to speak spontaneously	Spoke on the fly & did not prepare thoroughly
Focus on execution & practicality	No focus on execution
Risk averse	Risk taker

Learnings:

Guardian learnt a more spontaneous & engaging approach – more flexible.

Pioneer learnt about the benefits of preparation to get out of a tight spot.

Driver vs Integrator

Seek input from non dominant style members

When a team is dominated by one style (*generally Pioneers or Drivers*), **cascades** (discussions flowing in only one direction) can creep in:

1. **Informational cascade:** People assume early speakers know better
2. **Reputational cascade:** Fear of looking bad

- Ask people to **brainstorm on their own & decide agenda beforehand**
- Share ideas in a **round robin fashion** – ask minority styles first
- Gets diverse ideas into the mix before a particular direction gets momentum

Pay attention to introverts (Guardians & Quiet Integrators)

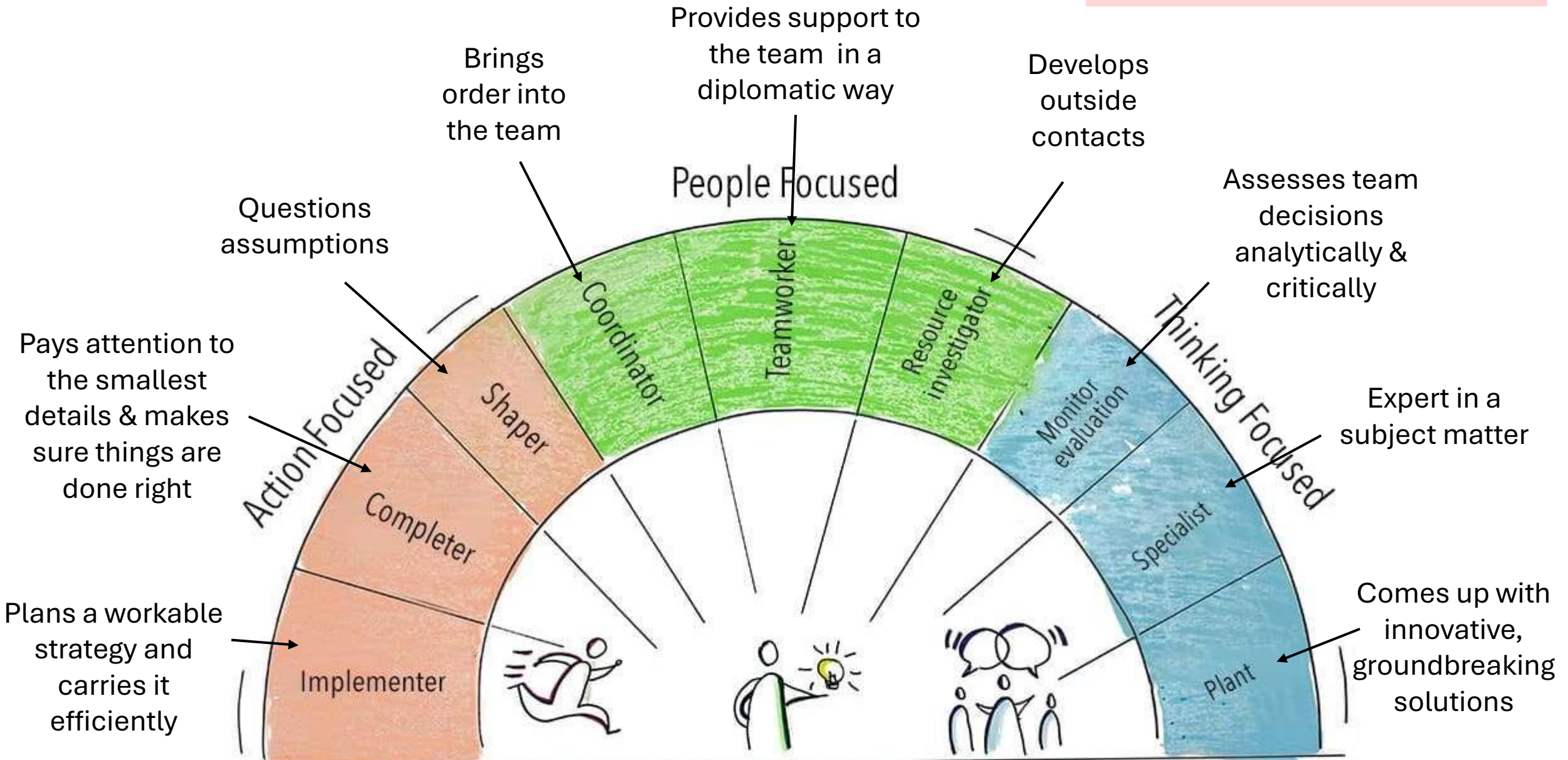
Guardians & Quiet Integrators are risk averse, so they don't generally stick their neck out & challenge status quo.

They are the most stressed out people.

- **Slow the pace, reduce information overload, give time to prepare**
- Give them more **alone time for reflective tasks**
- Divide teamwork oriented tasks from tasks that can be done in solitude
- Provide quieter or more private work environments
- Celebrate efforts even if something fails; Psychological safety

Belbin's 9 team role models

Disclaimer: Do not label any member with a particular role model. An individual can take up 4-6 roles depending on the situation. They may have a dominant style.



Belbin – People oriented roles

Disclaimer: Do not label any member with a particular role model. An individual can take up 4-6 roles depending on the situation. They may have a dominant style.

Role	Team Contribution	Allowable Weakness	Non-Allowable Weakness	Character Example (Harry Potter / Marvel)
Coordinator	Provides clarity and direction by **defining objectives** and **delegating** tasks effectively. **Creates an inclusive environment** where everyone contributes to shared goals.	Can be seen as **overly managerial, offloading personal tasks, or taking credit** for collective success.	Becomes **manipulative** or power-hungry; **controls** discussions and **suppresses alternative viewpoints.**	**Dumbledore / Nick Fury** — calm, strategic leaders who unify diverse personalities under one vision.
Team Worker	**Promotes team cohesion** through empathy, diplomacy, and collaboration. Keeps the **atmosphere positive** and ensures **smooth relationships** among members.	May **avoid difficult conversations** or decision-making to maintain harmony; can appear **indecisive.**	Consistently fails to take a stand when needed; **avoids responsibility**, causing drift or confusion.	**Neville Longbottom / Peter Parker (Spider-Man)** — loyal supporters who rally morale and inclusion.
Resource Investigator	Explores new opportunities, networks externally, and brings creative ideas, contacts, and enthusiasm to the team.	**Loses focus** after the excitement fades; promises more than can be delivered; **prone to distraction**.	**Abandons commitments**, fails to follow through, or neglects internal priorities for external stimulation.	**Fred & George Weasley / Tony Stark (Iron Man)** — extroverted, idea-rich, risk-embracing innovators.

Belbin – Thinking roles

Disclaimer: Do not label any member with a particular role model. An individual can take up 4-6 roles depending on the situation. They may have a dominant style.

Role	Team Contribution	Allowable Weakness	Non-Allowable Weakness	Character Example (Harry Potter / Marvel)
Plant	Generates **innovative and unconventional ideas**; the team's **creative spark** who sees solutions others miss.	Overly absorbed in their ideas, **inattentive to details or practical constraints**; may ignore feedback.	Ideas become **unrealistic or disconnected**; refuses collaboration or practical refinement.	**Luna Lovegood / Shuri** — visionary inventors who think differently and inspire fresh perspectives.
Monitor Evaluator	Provides **sober judgement, critical thinking, and objective analysis**. Evaluates proposals with logic and detachment.	May **lack emotional drive or passion**; perceived as **cold** or overly critical; **slow to decide.**	Paralyzes decisions through **endless caution**; demotivates others with constant **skepticism**.	**McGonagall / Vision** — rational analysts who value precision and integrity above excitement.
Specialist	Offers in-depth expertise, technical insight, and dedication to mastering their craft. Ensures accuracy and **knowledge leadership.**	Focused narrowly on own domain; **contributes little outside area of expertise**.	Becomes **isolated**, defensive of own knowledge, or **dismissive of broader team goals.**	**Hermione Granger / Bruce Banner (Hulk)** — brilliant specialists who deliver deep intellectual horsepower.

Belbin – Action oriented roles

Disclaimer: Do not label any member with a particular role model. An individual can take up 4-6 roles depending on the situation. They may have a dominant style.

Role	Team Contribution	Allowable Weakness	Non-Allowable Weakness	Character Example (Harry Potter / Marvel)
Shaper	**Energizes the team, drives momentum**, and thrives under pressure. Challenges inertia and complacency with urgency and determination.	Can be argumentative or **impatient; may hurt feelings** in the pursuit of progress.	**Becomes aggressive**, domineering, or dismissive; creates destructive conflict and burnout.	**Harry Potter / Captain America** — determined leaders who push through adversity to keep teams moving.
Implementer	**Turns strategies into actionable steps; organized, disciplined, and practical**. Converts ideas into efficient, workable systems.	May **resist change or new ideas; prefers familiar methods**; **slow to adapt**.	**Rigidly blocks innovation**; insists on routine at the expense of adaptability.	**Percy Weasley / War Machine (Rhodey)** — disciplined executors who uphold structure and consistency.
Completer Finisher	**Ensures thoroughness and attention to detail; monitors deadlines**, quality, and accuracy. Guarantees delivery meets high standards.	Can **worry excessively** or take over others' work to ensure quality; finds it hard to delegate.	Becomes anxious, **perfectionistic**, and obstructive; delays progress due to **over checking.**	**Molly Weasley / Pepper Potts** — meticulous caretakers who ensure nothing slips through the cracks.

Unbalanced team problems

Role (Too Many Of…)	Typical Symptoms / Outcomes
Coordinators	Endless meetings, leadership conflicts, lack of accountability.
Team Workers	Conflict avoidance, indecision, slow progress due to over-consultation.
Resource Investigators	Too many new ideas, little completion; chasing every opportunity.
Plants	Conflicting ideas, lack of implementation, frequent scope changes.
Monitor Evaluators	Over-critical culture, slow decisions, risk aversion, analysis-paralysis.
Specialists	Poor collaboration, jargon-heavy communication, tunnel vision.
Shapers	Frequent clashes, stress, ego conflicts, poor listening.
Implementers	Stifled innovation, bureaucratic processes, “we’ve always done it this way” mindset.
Completer Finishers	Overchecking, delays, micromanagement, low delegation.

Belbin’s Team Roles: Applying Role Awareness

Understanding and applying Belbin's roles is crucial for maximising team effectiveness and individual contribution.

Natural or Preferred Roles

Your strongest contributions; roles that come most easily and feel authentic.

Manageable Roles

Roles you can perform when necessary, though they may require more effort.

Least Preferred Roles

Roles that drain energy and should be avoided or delegated to others.

Choosing the Right Role & Effective Use

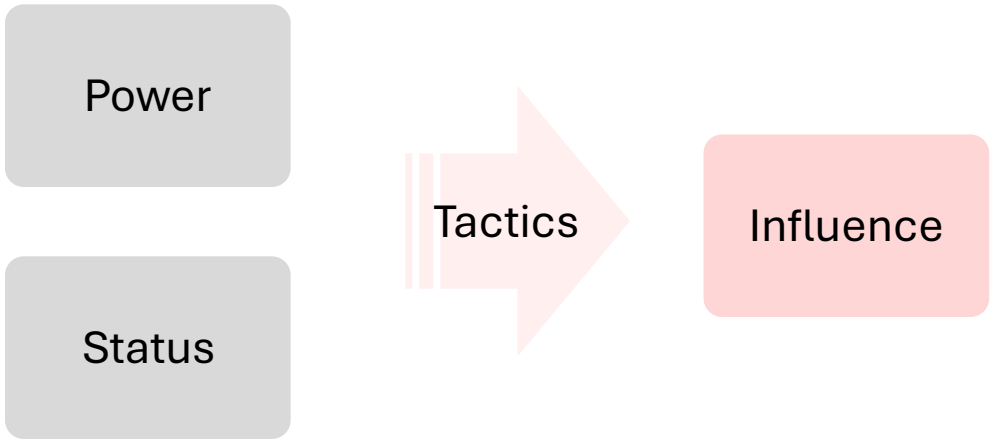
Role Selection

- Play to your top preferred roles whenever possible.
- Choose the role that fits the situation, task, and team composition.
- Be willing to "flex" into a manageable role when required.
- Allow teammates to cover your weaker areas.

Effective Typology Use

- Be conscious of the roles you assume and fill team gaps.
- Individuals can switch between 4–6 roles; avoid rigid labelling.
- Beware of overplaying a single role — balance is key.
- Role presence doesn't guarantee success; quality of interaction matters more.

Power & Influence



Session 6

Cases

1. Paul McGinley: Leading a multinational team of individuals

Readings

1. Tactics Of Influence

Slides

- **Sources of Power**
- **Tactics of Influence**
- **Status**

Sources of Power	What it Means	Reference to Paul McGinley Case
1. Positional Power	Power derived from one's formal role or authority within a structure.	—
1.1 Legitimate Power	Influence based on the formal right to make decisions because of one's position in the hierarchy.	As official captain appointed by the Players' Committee, McGinley possessed legitimate power to make strategic and administrative decisions He used it judiciously and transparently to maintain trust.
1.2 Coercive Power	Ability to influence through fear of negative consequences such as punishment or exclusion.	**Paul McGinley did not use this source of power.**
1.3 Reward Power	Ability to influence by offering valued rewards — monetary, recognition, or opportunities.	**Paul McGinley did not use this source of power.**
2. Personal Power	Power that stems from an individual's qualities, competence, or charisma rather than position.	—
2.1 Expert Power	Influence derived from special knowledge, skills, or expertise recognized by others. Record of accomplishment.	McGinley's **data-driven tactical mastery** gave him expert power. He used analytics to design pairings and course strategies.
2.2 Referent Power	Influence gained from personal admiration, respect, and identification with the leader's character.	His **humility, past Ryder Cup success, and inclusive approach** made him admired and trusted.
3. Information Power	Control or access to critical knowledge that others need to perform effectively.	He **gathered nuanced intelligence** through data teams, caddies, and managers. By selectively sharing this information (e.g., performance stats, course insights), he subtly guided player decisions.
4. Relational / Network Power	Power arising from strong, trust-based relationships and the ability to connect or coordinate across networks.	McGinley cultivated **deep ties with vice-captains, caddies, and support staff**, treating them as equals and empowering them to relay insights. These relationships extended his influence far beyond formal authority.

Tactics of Influence: Three Ways to Project Influence (Reading)

Tactic of Influence	What It Is	Supporting Evidence from the Case
Framing the Issue	**Shaping how others interpret** the problem, stakes, or solution. **Frames highlight meaning** and **align values**.	McGinley **framed the Ryder Cup not as Europe vs USA, but as "an exam at Gleneagles" and a mission of continental pride**. He emphasized playing for one's community and family, reframing motivation around identity and shared purpose.
Using Evidence and Information	Supporting arguments with **accurate & relevant facts**, logic, or selective data to **build rationality, objectivity & credibility.**	He used **analytics** to decide pairings (e.g., par-5 scoring data), built performance profiles of players, and **tailored practice plans** accordingly. Shared **selective stats** with players to **justify decisions objectively.**
Leveraging Technical Authority	Gaining influence by demonstrating **deep expertise, preparation,** or **subject mastery**.	Widely respected for **tactical competence and preparation**. Players acknowledged him as "the most prepared captain," and trusted his strategies without questioning—even when egos were involved.

Influence Tactic	What It Means	Reference / Example
Rational Persuasion (positive relationships with both task- and relationship-oriented outcomes)	**Using logic, data, or evidence** to make a **convincing argument** for a course of action.	McGinley used **analytics** to rationally justify team pairings and strategy, describing the course as an "exam" to be studied. His **data-driven approach earned credibility** among players.
Inspirational Appeal (positive relationships with both task- and relationship-oriented outcomes)	Appealing to **values, ideals, or emotions** to **inspire commitment**.	He appealed to pride in national and continental identity, telling players they **represented their towns, families, and Europe**. This created **emotional unity and motivation.**
Consultation (positive relationships with both task- and relationship-oriented outcomes)	Seeking **others' input** to **increase ownership and commitment** to a decision.	McGinley sought **feedback from vice-captains and caddies** before finalizing pairings. This participative style built buy-in and **trust**.
Collaboration (positive relationships with both task- and relationship-oriented outcomes)	Offering **support** or resources to help others carry out a request.	He treated all stakeholders—players, caddies, and staff—as **equals**, ensuring shared facilities and information. This reinforced **cooperation and mutual respect.**
Apprising (positive relationships with both task- and relationship-oriented outcomes)	Explaining how following a request benefits the target personally (e.g., recognition, growth).	McGinley framed the Ryder Cup victory as a way to enhance each golfer's **legacy** and **reputation**, making the team's **success personally meaningful**.

Influence Tactic	What It Means	Reference / Example
Ingratiation	Using praise or positive reinforcement to increase receptiveness before making a request.	He frequently acknowledged and praised players and caddies, creating goodwill and reinforcing his inclusive leadership.
Exchange	Offering something of value in return for cooperation.	McGinley did not rely on transactional exchanges. Alternate example: a manager promising schedule flexibility in return for extra work.
Personal Appeals	Requesting compliance based on friendship or personal loyalty.	McGinley emphasized professionalism over personal favors. Alternate example: a leader asking a long-time colleague for support on a key initiative.
Pressure	Using demands, threats, or repeated checking to secure compliance.	McGinley did not use pressure. Alternate example: a sales manager threatening underperformers with reassignment.
Legitimating	Justifying actions through formal authority, rules, or precedent.	He occasionally referred to his formal captaincy when setting match rosters, though he generally preferred persuasion over command.
Coalition	Gaining support from others to strengthen influence over a target.	He built a united leadership front through his vice-captains and caddies, who amplified his decisions and helped maintain consistency across the team.

Status: Push & Pull Strategy

Push Behaviours: Raising my status to lower yours

- Asserting Dominance
- Competing
- Exclusions
- Criticism



Pull: Lowering my status to raise yours

- Collaboration
- Supporting
- Inclusion
- Complimenting
- Listening and following up



McGinley followed the Pull Strategy

Teams & Cross Cultural Challenges

Session 8

Cases

1. Henry Tam and the MGI team

Readings

1. Managing Multicultural Teams

Slides

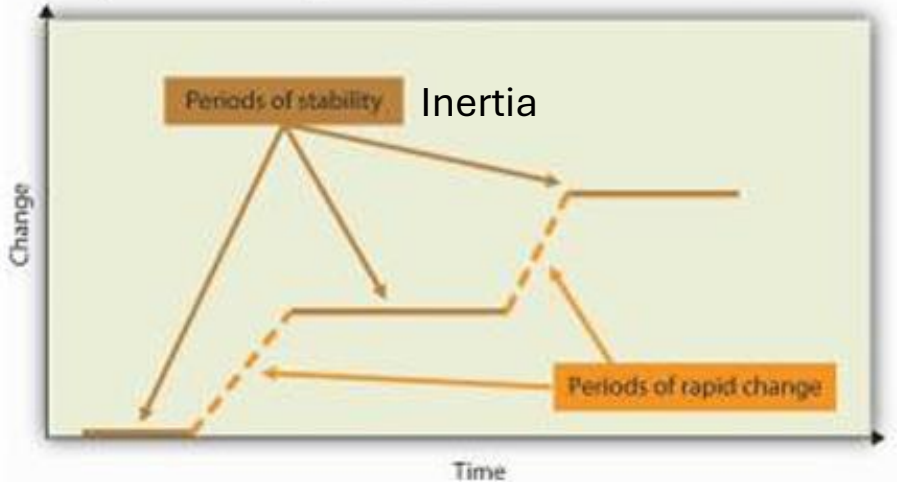
- **Stages of team development**
- **Punctuated Equilibrium Model**
- **MGI: Conflicts & Possible Resolutions**
- **Diversity**
- **Cultural Intelligence**

Tuckman's Stages of Team Development

Stage	What Happens (Session 8 Concepts)	Evidence from the Henry Tam & MGI Case
1. Forming	• *Team members first **come together**.* • *Orientation phase.* • *Becoming **acquainted**, understanding skill-sets.* • *Discussion of **team goals, individual goals, roles, ground rules**, **timelines**, etc.*	Henry and Dana meet Sasha and Igor for the first time at HBS; everyone polite, exploratory. But roles and purpose are unclear – Henry wonders if they are "business plan writers" or "strategic partners."
2. Storming	• *Emergence of **conflicts**.* • *Personality related / working styles.* • *Danger of **factions or cliques** getting formed. Some members feeling left out or **isolated**.*	Tension between Dana and Sasha – repeated clashes on control, tone, and priorities ("Dana and I versus the Russians"). Igor mediates; Alex observes the "negative chemistry."
3. Norming	• ***Norms of behaviour** getting developed.* • *Individual idiosyncrasies getting accepted.* • *Members start to feel they are a group; increasing **cohesiveness.***	Henry and Dana start pre-meetings to set agendas and play good-cop/bad-cop; early coordination norms emerge. Igor begins trusting Henry's calm, structured approach.
4. Performing	• *High-level cohesion, trust.* • ***Improved efficiency/performance**.* • ***Clear strategies/processes** for issue resolution.*	Henry brings structure via PowerPoint draft; integrates inputs objectively. Musicians respect his "symbiosis" skill. Short burst of productivity before submission deadline.
5. Adjourning	• ***Completing the task. Breaking up the team**.* • *Members could feel anxiety, fear of future, sadness.* • *Leaders may **evaluate** lessons learned.*	Near contest deadline, fatigue and stress; Henry reflects it's the "biggest event of my HBS career" and worries what to learn from the chaos. Team parts ways post-submission.

Punctuated Equilibrium Model

- Groups remain static for long periods of time
  - Change is incremental
- Revolutionary change happens in brief, punctuated bursts.
  - Groups cycle between storming and performing stages
- Transitional windows are Opportunities for Innovation & Creativity



MGI Case Link

•**Phase 1 (Inertia):** Weeks of unfocused brainstorming; seven people, no decisions.

•**Midpoint Shock:** Business-plan deadline = “transition point.” Henry & Dana realize chaos, take charge, bring structure and slides.

•**Phase 2 (Reorientation):** Concrete drafts, role clarity, higher energy.

Diversity – Double Edged Sword

Diversity will be discussed in detail in a later topic

Differences in background, skills, & perspectives that influence how teams think and work.
Enhances creativity —but also increases chances of miscommunication & conflict if not managed well.

Types in MGI Team

Functional diversity: Musicians (Igor, Roman) vs. MBAs (Henry, Dana) vs. Technologist (Dav).

Educational diversity: Business, music, and engineering backgrounds.

Cultural / National diversity: Russians, American, Romanian—distinct norms and language.

Cognitive diversity: Creative intuition vs. analytical logic.

Outcome: Creative chaos fuelled novel ideas but also confusion ("too many visions, no decisions")

Desired Diversity

Cognitive > Functional > Demographic — managed inclusion turns potential into performance.

When Diversity Helps

- **Shared purpose & safety:** Clear goals and trust turn differences into creativity.
- **Good leadership & structure:** Norms, equal voice, and role clarity convert variety into ideas.
- **Moderate mix:** Enough difference for new thinking, enough similarity for cohesion.
- **Best for:** Knowledge, problem-solving, or creative tasks.

When Diversity Hurts

- **No shared vision:** Everyone had different motives
- **Weak leadership/norms or unsafe climate:** Leads to subgroups and hidden faultlines.
- **Routine work:** Adds friction, not value.
- **Unmanaged invisible diversity:** Different thinking or risk styles cause quiet tension.

MGI Case: Conflicts & Possible Resolutions

Conflicts will be discussed again in Global & Virtual team challenges

	Task	Interpersonal	Status	Cultural
Concept	Disagreement on **what** the team should do — **goals, priorities, or strategy.**	**Personality** and **communication clashes** that trigger **emotional friction**.	Disputes over **influence & authority**: whose expertise carries more weight.	Misalignment in **communication norms** and **work values**.
MGI Case Evidence	Henry & Dana wanted to focus on the education market (smaller but feasible); Sasha & the founders insisted on entertainment (bigger but riskier).	Sasha's blunt criticism ("that's bullshit") clashed with Dana's formal, analytical tone and both stopped listening.	Founders saw themselves as owners; HBS students assumed project leadership; unclear hierarchy created ego friction.	Russians (Sasha, Igor, Roman) valued expressive, emotional debate; HBS students preferred structured, polite discussion.
Solutions	• **Align on criteria** for evaluating alternatives before debating (e.g., short-term ROI vs long-term scalability).	• Set **ground rules** for **respectful communication** & feedback. • Encourage **perspective-taking exercises** ("explain the other person's view") to rebuild respect.	• Hold an **early role-mapping session** to **define decision domains**. • Reinforce mutual recognition of expertise to **reduce insecurity**.	• Conduct a brief "**ways-of-working**" check-in to surface **cultural expectations**. • Incorporate **informal** cross-cultural interactions **(meals, social chats)** to build empathy.

Cultural Intelligence

Cultural intelligence is defined as "a person's capability for successful adaptation to new cultural settings"

- Emotional/ motivational – Willingness to adapt
- Cognitive - Understanding norms
- Physical - Adjusting actions

MGI Case Illustration

- **Low CQ moments:** Sasha's blunt critique offended Dana; Henry misread Russian directness as aggression.
- **High CQ moments:** Alex explained that "with creative people you have to waste time"—helped Dana interpret musicians' style.
- **Henry's growth:** Learned to mirror passionate tone to earn respect ("I raised my voice—they respected that").

Impact:
In MGI, lack of CQ turned cultural richness into relational tensions

What is Inter-Cultural Competence?
'transcending the limitations of one's own world view'

ICC is NOT An approach to changing our natural behaviour

"The learner of a second or foreign language and culture does not cease to be competent in his or her mother tongue and the associated culture."

Global & Virtual Team Challenges

Session 9

Cases

1. Managing a global team: Greg James at Sun Microsystems, Inc. (A)

Readings

1. Managing Yourself Getting Virtual Teams Right
2. Making The Hybrid Workplace Fair (HBR)
3. Developing Team Trust: Leader Insights For Virtual Settings

Slides

- **Greg James case: Virtual team challenges & solutions**
- **Types of conflicts**
- **Interpersonal trust**
  - **ABI Model**
  - **Affective – Cognitive model**
  - **Building trust in virtual teams**

Global & Virtual team **Challenges**

1 Conflicts

Relationship, task, process, status – can take different forms

2 Trust deficit

Low confidence in teammates' competence, reliability and intent

3 Accountability & Visibility Blur

Opportunity to hide behind virtual wall
Not seen in office – lower recall



4 Communication & information gaps

Slower access to info in comparison to in office employees
Lack of informal water cooler convo – FOMO

5 Cultural/Time zone gaps

"Follow-the-sun" model unfair and fragmented.
Have to work longer hours

6 Resource Constraints

Weaker remote tech setup, slow connections

Greg James Case: Conflicts & Possible Resolutions

Conflicts discussed in Teams & Cross Cultural Challenges

	Task	Process	Status	Relationship
Concept	Disagreement on **what** the team should do — **goals, priorities, or strategy.**	Disagreement about **how** work should be carried out – **methods, timelines, or decision rules.**	Disputes over **influence & authority**: whose expertise carries more weight.	Clash of **personalities or communication styles**
Greg James Case Evidence	• Dispute over cause of HS Holdings outage (India vs Dubai). • Unclear who programmed the faulty queue. • US team felt Mumbai should've fixed the problem themselves.	• India used weekday protocol on weekend. • Global call timing (8 AM US = 8:30 PM India) caused fatigue. • Escalation path for emergencies was ambiguous.	• French team earned ≈30% less than US peers. • UAE feared subordination to India. • Non-US teams viewed US as "favorites."	• Nick insulted Indian team ("not competent"). • Praveen avoided calling Nick directly. • Emotional tension between regional leads (Rahul–Nick).
Solutions	• **Clarify task ownership & deliverables.** • Create **shared documentation** and **accountability map**	• **Standardize workflow & escalation norms.** • **Rotate meeting times** to share time-zone load.	• Make **recognition** and **pay criteria transparent.** • **Rotate leadership visibility** across sites.	• **Facilitate cross-cultural dialogue & feedback**. • Reinforce **psychological** safety and **respect norms**

Greg James Case: Global & Virtual Team Challenges

Trust deficit

- India and Dubai teams doubted US engineers' intentions and fairness.
- French team felt their inputs were ignored by HQ.
- Greg assumed trust existed — didn't sense how alienated remote sites felt.

Set **shared goals & risks**, **explicit team norms**, and **lightweight engagement checks** to build cognitive + affective trust.

Accountability & Visibility

- Remote engineers' work went unnoticed; only US team visible to leadership.
- Difficult to trace who owned the failed queue; no shared accountability map.
- "Out of sight, out of mind" dynamic weakened follow-through.

Use a **RACI + incident owner** for each system, and a **shared dashboard** (visibility)

Communication/Info Gap

- Outage details reached Greg hours late; scattered email threads created confusion.
- No common real-time platform for coordination.
- Lack of informal "hallway" updates bred misunderstanding and blame.

Stand up a **single crisis channel + runbook** & follow with **post-mortems** to learn.

Cultural & Time-Zone Barriers

- 8 AM US = 8:30 PM India; late-night calls drained non-US teams.
- UAE site followed weekend protocol, others missed it. ME takes more time.
- Differing norms of authority and feedback style caused tension.

Rotate meeting windows, run **cross-cultural feedback drills** to create psychological safety.

Resource Constraint

- Weaker tech setup in some regions; slow network hampered quick diagnosis.
- Limited access to key systems from offshore sites during crisis.
- US office had superior tools and visibility dashboards.

Equalizing tool access & info visibility; **redistribute visibility** (rotating presenters).

Other Challenges

Compensation disparity:
French engineers earned ~30% less than US peers, creating resentment and feelings of inequity.

Recognition bias:
US team got more credit and visibility during crisis recovery; remote sites felt invisible.

Getting Virtual Teams Right (Reading) & Making the Hybrid Workplace Fair (Reading)

1. Get the Right Team

- **Right people:** Good communication skills, high emotional & cultural intelligence, ability to work independently
- **Right size:** Smaller teams (<10 people)
- **Right roles**: Define 3 role tiers: core (strategy), operational (day-to-day) & outer (temporary/contract workers).

2. Assign the Right Leadership

- **Fostering trust:** Both cognitive & affective trust
- **Encouraging open dialogue:** Ensure psychological safety for everyone to speak up; notice who speaks up & who doesn't
- **Clarifying goals & guidelines:** Shared goals; Clear protocols for escalation & work in general
- **Do not multitask:** Both leader & team members

3. Establish the Right Touchpoints

- Initial **Kick-off** meeting
- **Proper onboarding:** Welcome meeting & tour, fly-in to HQ
- **Milestones:** Celebrate & appreciate short term wins
- **Emotional support**

4. Implement the Right Technology

- Conference Calling
- Direct calling & text messaging
- Discussion forums & virtual team rooms
- Ensure collaboration across all channels

As a leader

Track & Communicate	Design	Educate	Monitor
Map who is working from where & when	Redesign structures to improve resource availability & visibility	Educate employees to avoid hybrid bias	Performance reviews, team launches, onboarding

Interpersonal Trust: ABI Model

	Definition	What it means for you?
Ability	The skills and competencies that enable a person to have influence in a specific area.	"Does my teammate have the skills to get their part of the job done well?"
Benevolence	The extent to which a person is believed to want to do good for the team, aside from any personal motives.	"Does my teammate genuinely care about the team's success and my well-being?"
Integrity	The perception that a person adheres to a set of principles that you find acceptable, such as honesty and fairness.	"Is my teammate reliable, consistent, and principled in their actions? Can I depend on their word?"

Mayer, R. C., Davis, J. H., & Schoorman, F. D. (1995). An integrative model of organizational trust. *Academy of management Review*, *20*(3), 709-734.

Interpersonal Trust: Affective-Cognitive Model (Reading)

Cognitive trust (Head)



"You do what you say."
About **competence**, **predictability**, and **follow-through**.

How leaders build *cognitive* trust?

- **Align goals & risks:** Say what success is and why it matters to everyone.
- **Set clear norms:** Meeting etiquette, response times, tools to use.
- **Watch engagement (lightly):** Check in regularly, but avoid Zoom fatigue.
- **Clarify roles:** Who owns what; how to escalate; be ready to adjust.

Affective trust (Heart)



"You care about me and the team."
About **closeness**, **benevolence**, and **shared identity**.

How leaders build *affective* trust?

- **Create psychological safety:** Invite dissent; thank people for speaking up.
- **Show commitment to people:** Provide access to resources, support & autonomy.
- **Connect beyond work:** Short optional coffees; celebrate milestones.
- **Encourage collaboration/backups:** Keep others in the loop; name "second-in-command."

Why both matter (especially remote/hybrid)?

- **Cognitive** → coordination & quality; **Affective** → voice, resilience, learning.
- In virtual contexts, casual cues shrink—leaders must **design** both forms of trust.

Group Decision Making

Session 10-11

Readings

1. A Note on Team Process

Slides & Class Exercise

- **Synergy, Conformity & IPO Model**
- **Effective team processes & process losses**
- **Team development, teamwork & globalization – Concepts covered in previous topics**

Synergy, Conformity & IPO Model

Actual Productivity	=	Potential Productivity	+	Synergy (*Improve* ↑)	-	Process Losses (*Reduce* ↓)

Team doing better than individuals.
But how?

- Integrate information from diverse views
- Motivational pull
- De-biasing

- Decision making
- Participation
- Conflict
- Influence
- Communication

Conformity – what are some signals to look for?

- Does nobody question the team decisions?
- Is no one in the team questioning the status quo when needed?
- Are there no alternate viewpoints emerging?
- Are the group/team norms preventing individuals from questioning team decision?

IPO Model

INPUTS
Interdependence
Team Goals
Self-Leadership
Team Composition

↓

PROCESSES
Conflict
Decision making
Participation & Influence
Communication

↓

OUTCOME
Productivity
Satisfaction
Viability

Effective Team Processes & Process Losses

Decision Making

4 disciplined steps:

1) **Identify & frame** the real problem
2) **Generate** many alternatives in a climate of psychological safety
3) **Refine & critique** with data; aim for consensus but manage the trade-off
4) **Implement** with owners & timelines.

Common traps: "First decent solution," leader/opinion-leader bias, conflict avoidance, rushing the implement plan.

Decision Rules

- Majority rule
- Minority rule
- Voting
- Consensus
- Qualified consensus

Participation

- **Uneven participation hurts quality & commitment** Track who talks, to whom, and when shifts occur.
- **Gatekeep for equity:** Invite, loop back, and reinforce under-heard points. Query silent members directly.
- **Influence ≠ airtime:** Some speak little but shape direction; beware dominance by status/loudness over expertise.

Consequences of Uneven Participation:

Social Loafing: The tendency for people to apply less effort when they're part of a group. Some loafers perceive that others in the group are slacking, so they feel justified in exerting less effort

Bystander Effect: Diffusion of responsibility

Conflict

Discussed previously

Encourage **task conflict** (ideas) while minimizing **affective/relationship conflict** (personal)

Influence

Discussed previously

- Sources of Power
- Tactics of Influence
- Status

Diversity

“the condition of having or being composed of differing elements : variety

Session 13-14

Cases

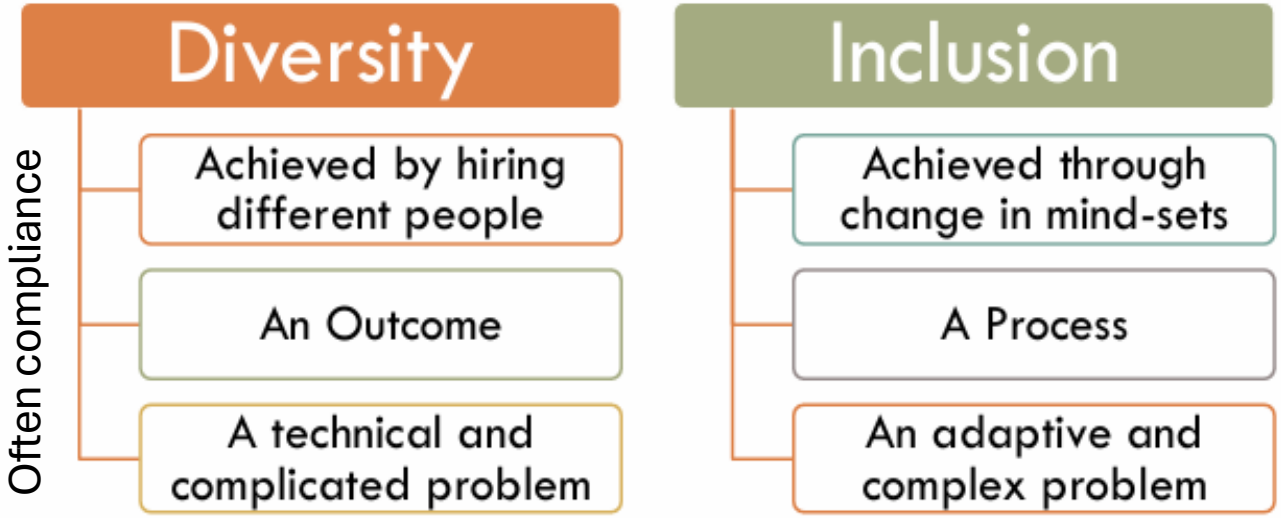
1. Diversity Vignettes

Readings

1. The Business Case for Commitment to Diversity

Slides & Class Exercise

- **Diversity vs Inclusion**
- **Surface level vs Deep level Diversity**
- **Equity, Equality & Need**
- **Psychology of Exclusion - Recipient, Source & Bystander**
- **Diversity Vignettes**



Inclusion

Is…

- ✓ Sharing of ideas from all perspectives
- ✓ Valuing individuals and leveraging their diverse talent, not *in spite* of their differences, but *because* of them
- ✓ People working together despite differences
- ✓ Fostering a culture where differences of thought and opinions are embraced with enthusiasm and celebrated

Inclusion

Is not…

- × Creating the delusion that everyone will always get along.
- × Pretending to agree for the sake of avoiding conflict.
- × Ignoring the differences that may exist.

Diversity vs Inclusion

"Diversity is being invited to the party; Inclusion is being asked to dance."

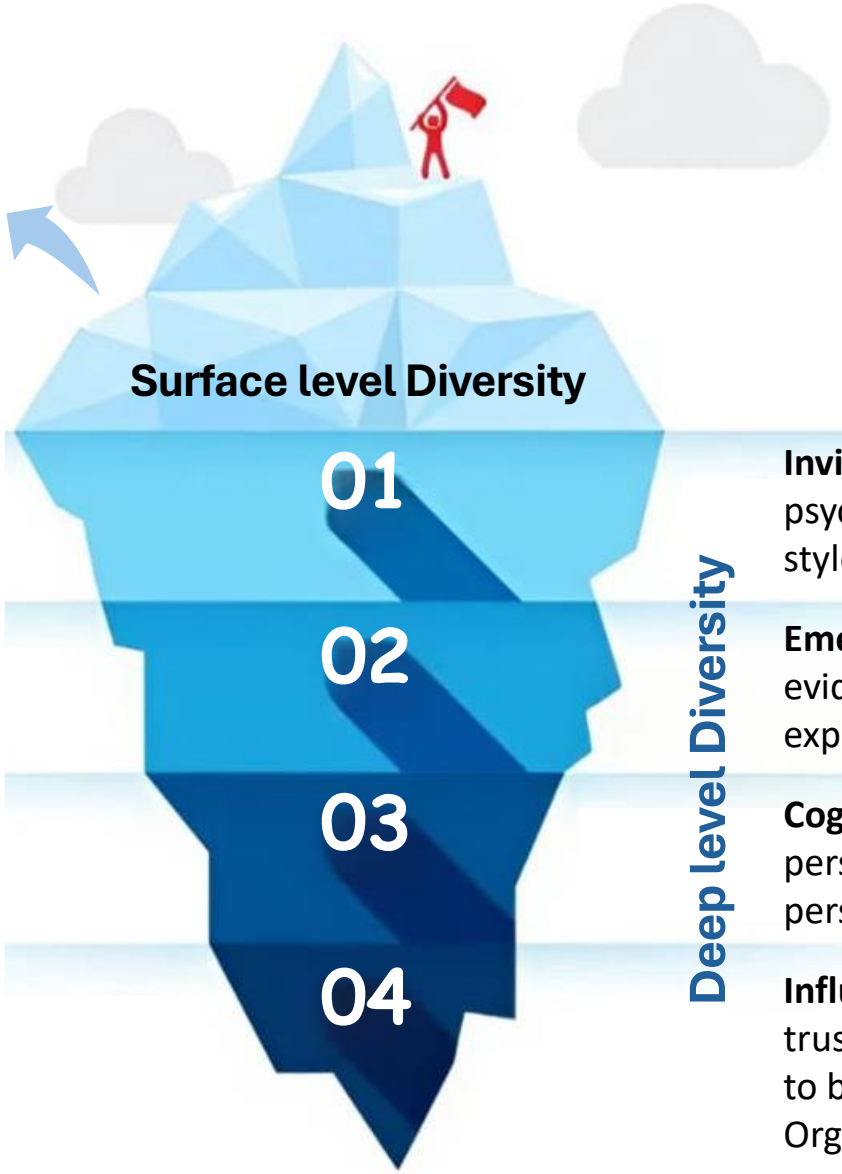
- a popular quote by Verna Myers

Surface level vs Deep level Diversity

Easily observable – Includes visible attributes like age, gender, race, and physical appearance.

Immediate impact – Shapes first impressions and initial judgments in teams. Its influence reduces as people interact and deeper traits become more visible.

Demographic in nature – Often used for representation and compliance measures in organizations. – Org Impact



Invisible initially: It includes underlying psychological traits, beliefs, values, and thinking styles that are not immediately observable.

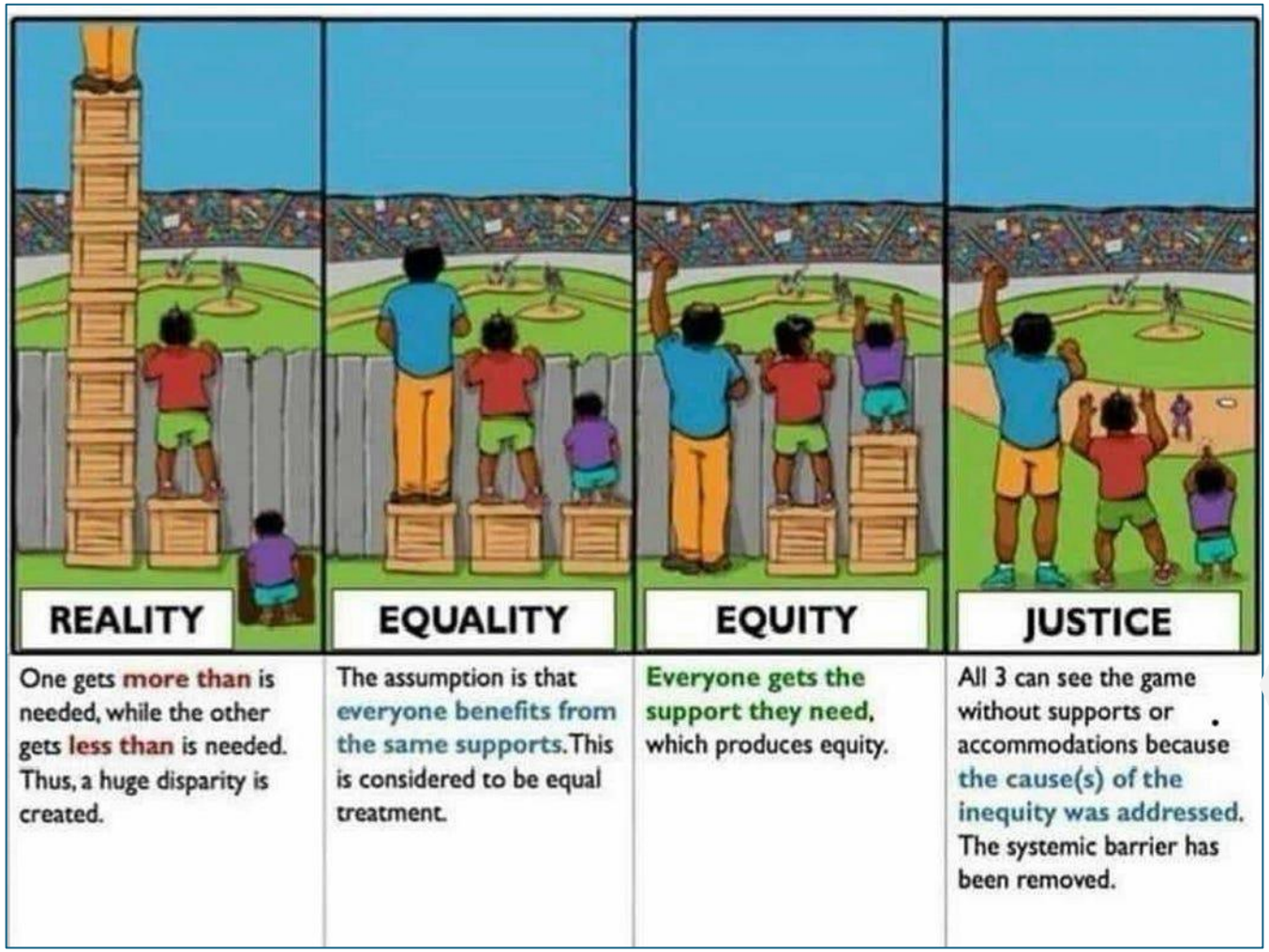
Emerges over time: These differences become evident only as team members interact and share experiences.

Cognitive and value-based: Focuses on diversity in perspectives, problem-solving approaches, and personal values rather than demographic traits.

Influences performance: Affects communication, trust, and innovation within teams — often leading to better long-term collaboration and creativity – Org Impact.

Deep vs Surface level diversity can be related to most of the Vignette cases

Equality, Equity, Need & Fairness



Fairness – Types of Justice

Distributive Justice

"Are rewards distributed fairly?"

Fairness of **outcomes:** who gets what (pay, rewards, promotions).

Procedural Justice

"Were decisions made transparently and consistently?"

Fairness of **processes** used to make decisions.

Interactional Justice

"Was I treated with dignity and respect?"

Fairness in treatment and communication during interactions.

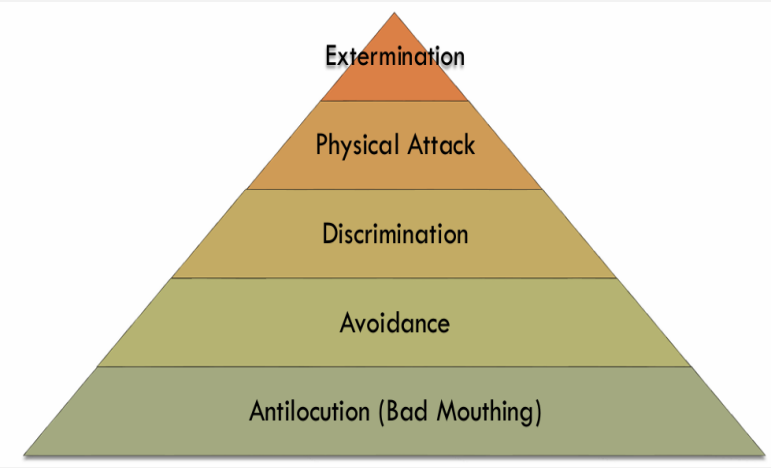
Equality, Equity, Need & Fairness

	Equality	Equity	Need
Logic	Everyone is **treated the same** regardless of differences.	Rewards and resources are given in proportion to **input, individual effort, or performance.**	People with greater personal or situational needs receive more support or flexibility.
Fairness via	Focuses on **consistency** and uniform rules for all.	Focuses on **merit and contribution**, rewarding based on what each person delivers.	Focuses on **compassion and solidarity**, ensuring well-being and inclusion.
Organizational Impact (Positive)	Builds **trust** and perception of fairness in processes.	Drives **motivation and performance**, encouraging representation & innovation	Fosters a **culture of care** & psychological safety. Belongingness & Well-being.
Organizational Impact (Negative)	Can **ignore individual differences** in effort or need.	May restrict access for those **starting with fewer advantages**.	Can be **seen as unfair by high performers** who value merit-based systems.
Examples	Same annual bonus percentage to all employees; standardized recruitment processes.	Performance-linked pay; targeted leadership development for top contributors.	Extra leave or financial support for employees in crisis; childcare, flexible work hours, or mental health programs.
Vignette Example	*"Red Lipstick and Sleeveless Blouse"* — everyone judged by the same "professional dress" rule, ignoring that norms differ culturally.	*"High Heel"* — valuing individuals who "fit" dominant norms of behavior; merit recognition depends on perceived appropriateness.	*"If You Insist"* — inclusion requires sensitivity to disability; adapting language ("See you") shows meeting different needs.

Psychology of Exclusion - Recipient, Source & Bystander

Ways in which majority group keep control & hold power:

- Exaggerate
- Difference
- Attach Labels
- Impose Values
- Hold Power
- Stereotype
- Impose Traditions
- Define What's Normal
- Make Rules



Allport's Scale of Prejudice

Recipient - ACTION

- Stay calm and **address the issue with facts, not emotion**.
- Explain how the remark or behavior made you feel.
- **Seek clarification or support proactively** if the situation continues.

Source - ASSIST

- **Listen** without defensiveness and **acknowledge** the concern.
- **Apologize sincerely and focus on the impact, not intent**.
- **Reflect** on and **correct** your own assumptions or bias.

Bystander - ARISE

- **Speak up** respectfully when you notice exclusion or bias.
- **Support** the person being excluded, both **publicly** and **privately**.
- Encourage an open, respectful discussion to rebuild trust.

Diversity Vignettes Case: What could have been done?

Red Lipstick & Sleeveless Blouse - Gender & Appearance Diversity

Recipient: Stay calm; ask clarifying questions ("Could you explain what's inappropriate?"); express how the comment made her feel without confrontation.

Source: Make people aware beforehand; Reflect on bias linking dress to professionalism; focus on competence not appearance.

Bystander: Intervene politely ("I think dress code expectations should be consistent for everyone");

During a Presentation - Gender & Communication Style Diversity

Recipient: Clarify the interruption or dismissive tone respectfully ("Let me complete this point first"); keep composure.

Source: Avoid dominating; listen actively and ensure equal speaking time.

Bystander: Redirect conversation ("Let's allow her to finish — I want to hear her perspective.").

If You Insist - Disability Diversity

Recipient: Respond without over-apologizing; help educate if safe ("Actually, I'm visually impaired — maybe we can say 'Catch up later' instead.").

Source: Acknowledge unintentional insensitivity; apologize and thank for correction; be more mindful in future interactions.

Bystander: Step in empathetically ("That phrase can sound exclusionary — easy to miss, but good to note.").

Why Don't You? - Socioeconomic / Cultural Diversity

Recipient: Assert boundaries kindly ("That's a personal choice; I'm comfortable as I am.").

Source: Avoid making assumptions or advice based on stereotypes; listen and learn about different experiences.

Bystander: Reframe the conversation ("Everyone's journey is different; let's respect that.").

Diversity Vignettes Case: What could have been done?

Hey Kiddo - Age & Generational Diversity

Recipient: Use “I” statements (“I feel undermined when called ‘kiddo’; could we use my name instead?”).

Source: Recognize condescending tone; apologize and shift to professional address.

Bystander: Model respect (“She’s made valid points — let’s hear her out fully.”).

Lose Some Weight - Body Diversity / Lookism

Recipient: State discomfort calmly (“That comment felt personal and unrelated to work.”).

Source: Reflect on inappropriate personal feedback; apologize and avoid body-related remarks.

Bystander: Divert and correct (“Let’s keep feedback focused on performance, not appearance.”).

Soft Light and Sounds, Please - Neurodiversity / Sensory Sensitivity

Recipient: Communicate accessibility needs clearly and early (“Soft lighting helps me focus better.”).

Source: Respond supportively; accommodate the request without judgment.

Bystander: Reinforce empathy (“Let’s adjust the setup — small changes help everyone work better.”).

Guest Faculty from Industry: Managing and Leading Multicultural Teams

Session 12

Topics (Not Exhaustive)

1. Not Invented Here (NIH)
2. Mergers: Cultural Gravity

Managing Teams in Crisis

Material will be attached by mid-term, once class slides are uploaded.

Session 15

Cases

1. Asian Toys

Readings

1. The Myth of the Top Management Team

Slides & Class Exercise

Thank You & All the Best for Mid-Term